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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The Trump family's** World Liberty Financial is launching a stablecoin, its latest bid to capitalize on a crypto-market revival kindled by the president's election. **A1**

◆ **Investors' hopes** for a moderate outcome on tariffs helped lift U.S. stocks, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq climbing 0.2% and 0.5%, respectively, and the Dow gaining less than 0.1%. **B11**

◆ **A key consumer survey** showed a fall in household sentiment in March, adding to evidence that people are taking a more negative view of the economy. **A2**

◆ **The Pentagon's award** to Boeing of a contract to build the next-generation jet fighter threw a lifeline to the beleaguered company in the form of a guaranteed profit through the development phase. **B1**

◆ **Samsung Electronics** co-CEO Jun Young-hyun will take over as the electronics company's sole leader following the sudden death of his counterpart, Jong-hee Han. **B1**

◆ **Tesla's sales in the** European Union plunged for the second consecutive month in February despite an overall increase in demand for electric vehicles. **B3**

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World-Wide

◆ **Trump and two of his** top intelligence officials denied that classified materials about military strikes in Yemen were shared by officials on a group chat on a nongovernment service, while Democrats denounced the security breach as reckless and dangerous. **A1, A4**

◆ **The U.S. said it would** help Russia boost agricultural exports and restore its access to payments systems after the Kremlin demanded the easing of Western sanctions in return for a cease-fire in the Black Sea. **A1**

◆ **Trump signed an order** that aims to reshape how elections are conducted by setting new voter-registration ID requirements and prohibiting the counting of absentee or mail-in ballots received after Election Day. **A3**

◆ **Trump signed an** executive order targeting Jenner & Block, expanding his campaign of retribution against law firms he perceives as enemies. **A4**

◆ **The Trump administration** plans to freeze tens of millions of dollars in family-planning grants to certain organizations while it investigates whether the money was used for diversity efforts. **A3**

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From left, FBI Director Kash Patel, Director of National Intelligence Tulsi Gabbard and CIA Director John Ratcliffe testified before the Senate Intelligence Committee Tuesday, a day after the report of a group chat that contained U.S. airstrike plans.

Officials Minimize War-Plans Breach

Democrats challenge testimony that group chat on Yemen didn't share classified data

WASHINGTON—President Trump and two top intelligence officials denied on Tuesday that classified materials about military strikes in Yemen were shared by officials on a group chat on a nongovernment ser-

vice, while Democrats denounced the security breach as reckless and dangerous.

Tulsi Gabbard, the director of national intelligence, and John Ratcliffe, the director of the Central Intelligence Agency, told Congress Tuesday that the chat among senior officials over a pending military strike against Houthi militants earlier this month didn't include classified information.

The Atlantic on Monday re-

By Michael R. Gordon,
Tarini Parti
and Alex Leary

ported that the chat, on the platform Signal, included details of an imminent operation against the Houthis, including the targets to be hit and time they were to be struck.

Gabbard and Ratcliffe's claim, which was made in testimony to the Senate Intelli-

gence Committee, was challenged by several senators who said it wasn't plausible that a chat with such details could be unclassified.

"If that is the case, please release the whole text stream," said Sen. Angus King, a political

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◆ **Secret chat invite went to** object of Trump's ire..... **A4**

◆ **How Signal works and why** officials used it..... **A4**

Trump Family Venture Deepens Crypto Push

By VICKY GE HUANG

The Trump family's World Liberty Financial is launching a stablecoin, its latest bid to capitalize on a crypto-market revival kindled by the president's election.

World Liberty's USD1 will be backed by short-term U.S. Treasuries, U.S. dollar deposits, and other cash equivalents, the company said Tuesday. The token will be issued on the Ethereum network and a blockchain created by Binance, the crypto exchange

that has sought to forge closer ties to the president's family.

Stablecoins provide the backbone to the decentralized web of digital networks that comprise the crypto markets, functioning as digital dollars used widely to store cash or pay for purchases of other tokens. They aim to maintain a 1:1 exchange ratio with government-issued currencies, and store reserves in cash or cash-like assets such as Treasuries to keep the peg in place.

World Liberty's stablecoin

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INSIDE



JASON GAY

With no underdog team, March Madness surrenders to basketball powerhouses. **A12**

Wary Europe Eyes Own Nuclear Force

Doubts about U.S. commitment spur countries to consider weapons sharing

PARIS—Two weeks after Russia's large-scale invasion of Ukraine, French President

By Daniel Michaels,
Noemie Bissierbe and
Michael R. Gordon

Emmanuel Macron descended 20 stories beneath Paris to send a message to Moscow. He entered France's nu-

clear bunker deep under his regal presidential palace to lead an exercise dubbed Poker. Officials had chosen that night, in March 2022, for its clear skies. They wanted to respond to Russian President Vladimir Putin, who days earlier had made a thinly veiled threat to the West by putting his country's

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Water Fight Captivates Class of '25

It's douse or die in Senior Assassin; mole in the choir

By ROBERT McMILLAN

SAN FRANCISCO —A black Volvo rolled slowly down a quiet street while passengers armed with waterguns scanned for their target. Then at two minutes before 5 p.m., high-school senior Gabriel Pardini emerged from a YMCA.

From his middle seat, Graham Iwanchuk raised his Nerf Super Soaker XP35 and fired through an open window. Pardini never stood a chance. He was out of the game.

They were playing Senior Assassin, a citywide game of water-pistol tag that's become a rite of passage for students

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Office Downturn Leaves Park Avenue Unscathed

By PETER GRANT

The U.S.'s oldest and most venerable office districts are struggling to remain relevant during this period of changing work habits.

Then there's Park Avenue. The stately boulevard created in the late 1800s is still one of the hottest office markets in the country. Its towers, filled with white-shoe law firms, real-estate companies, insurers and giant money managers such as Blackstone, command some of the highest office rents anywhere.

The stretch of Park Avenue in Midtown Manhattan is the rare boulevard where companies are willing to pay up for a trophy address. Many CEOs still consider it as the premier location to call home.

"It's the best place you can be on the Monopoly board," said David Levinson, whose L&L Holding is the developer of the 47-story 425 Park Ave.,

new home to investment powerhouse Citadel. He recently leased the remaining floors to the State Bank of India.

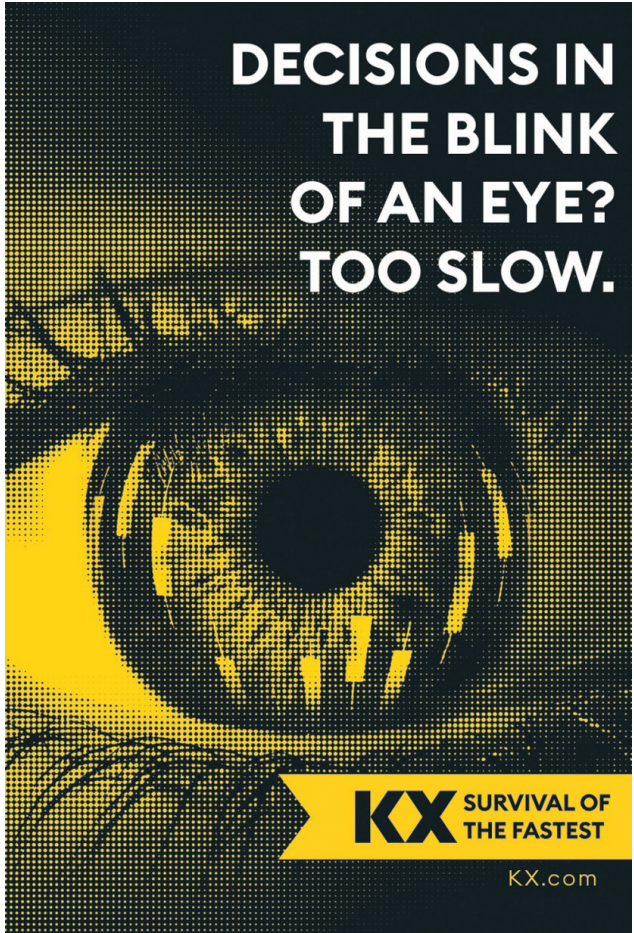
Just two blocks east, on Third Avenue, desperate landlords are offering 75% discounts to the going rates on Park Avenue. But tenants seeking the Park Avenue cachet aren't interested.

Financial firms are willing to pay in part because peers are based there. Churchill Asset Management was outgrowing its space in 430 Park Ave. Despite finding lower rents in the city's other business districts, the money manager signed a new lease at the Seagram Building, Ludwig Mies van der Rohe's midcentury-modern classic at 375 Park Ave.

"We're in good company," said Shai Vichness, Churchill's chief financial officer. "It makes it easier for investors when they're coming to see us that they can go up and down

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DECISIONS IN
THE BLINK
OF AN EYE?
TOO SLOW.



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